PROPOSAL · 9 JUNE 2026

Fund a Customer Success team

Three hires to stop the churn that's quietly costing us $1.2M a year.

The ask: fund three Customer Success roles, starting this quarter.

We are proposing three Customer Success hires at roughly $400K fully loaded. The case is simple: churn among our largest accounts is costing far more than the team would. This proposal makes the ask, justifies it, and asks again — so you can decide today.

The problem: our biggest accounts leave because no one owns them.

Accounts over $50K have no dedicated owner after the sale. They onboard themselves, hit friction, and churn at renewal — and we only find out when the renewal doesn't come. Sales can't catch it; support is reactive. Nobody's job is keeping these accounts successful.

- Eight of our top forty accounts churned or downgraded last year.
- Exit interviews cite "we never heard from anyone" as the top reason.

THE COST OF DOING NOTHING

$1.2M

in annual recurring revenue lost last year to large-account churn we could have seen coming.

What a Customer Success team would own.

01

A named owner per account

Every account over $50K gets one person accountable for its health.

02

Proactive check-ins

Quarterly business reviews catch friction before it reaches renewal.

03

A health score

Usage, support volume, and sentiment roll into one early-warning signal.

04

Renewal ownership

CS owns the renewal conversation, starting ninety days out.

Why three, and why now.

Three CS managers can each own about twenty-five large accounts — enough to cover our top seventy-five, which is where the churn concentrates. Waiting a quarter means another renewal cycle runs through the same gap that cost us $1.2M.

- The next major renewal window opens in October — three at-risk accounts in it.
- Three is the minimum that covers the at-risk segment without overloading.

PROPOSAL · YEAR-ONE TARGETS

What $400K in CS would return in the first year.

−60%

Large-account churn

FROM $1.2M TO UNDER $500K ON PLAN FINANCE

75

Accounts covered

THE ENTIRE AT-RISK SEGMENT
ON PLAN CS

3.5×

Return on cost

$1.4M RETAINED ON $400K SPEND
ON PLAN FINANCE

BENCHMARK · COMPANIES OUR SIZE

What peer companies see after staffing Customer Success.

From an industry survey of 60 SaaS companies at $10–30M ARR.

−55%	+18%	4 mo	+12
LARGE-ACCOUNT CHURN	NET REVENUE RETENTION	PAYBACK ON CS COST	NET PROMOTER SCORE

How we'd stand the team up in ninety days.

STEP 01

Hire the lead

Recruit an experienced CS lead first; they shape the playbook and hire the other two.

STEP 02

Segment the accounts

Rank the top seventy-five by churn risk so coverage starts where it matters.

STEP 03

Launch QBRs

Begin quarterly business reviews with the highest-risk accounts immediately.

STEP 04

Stand up the health score

Wire usage and support data into one dashboard by the end of the quarter.

The ask again: approve three CS hires this quarter.

FUND THE THREE CS ROLES

$400K to protect $1.2M and stop finding out about churn at renewal.

HOLD FOR ANOTHER QUARTER

Defers the cost, but runs the October renewals through the same blind spot.

CUSTOMER SUCCESS PROPOSAL · SUCCESS@EXAMPLE.COM

Three hires to protect $1.2M — let's fund them now.